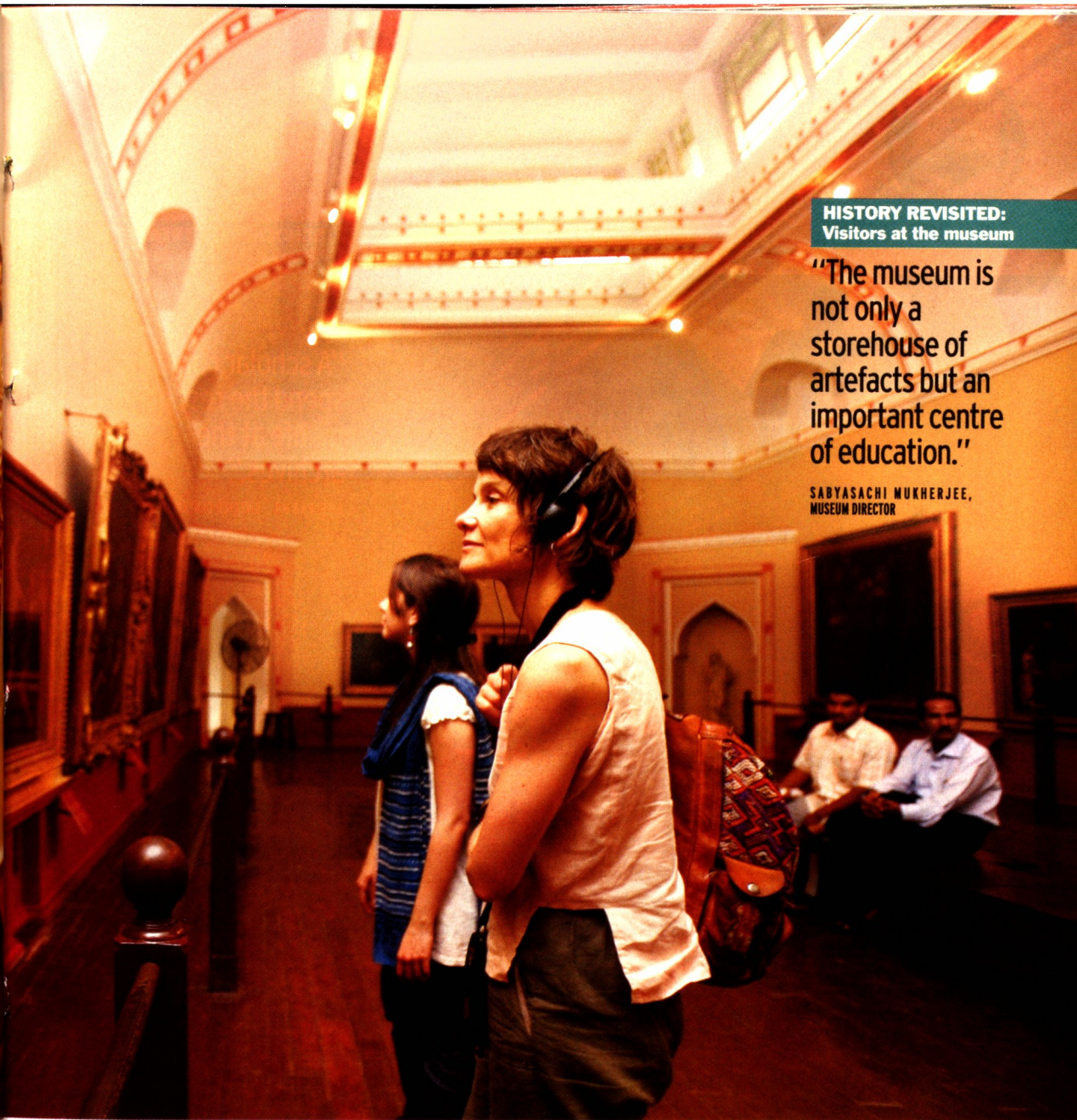




HISTORY REVISITED:
Visitors at the museum

"The museum is not only a storehouse of artefacts but an important centre of education."

SABYASACHI MUKHERJEE,
MUSEUM DIRECTOR

SUBIR K. PATI / SHODH

modern-day citizens to connect with their inheritance and enables history to breathe freely in a quicksilver present.

Prince of Wales Museum, this 86-year-old heritage precinct was inaugurated in honour of his visit to India in 1905 and then opened to the public in 1922. Designed by George Wittet in the Indo-Saracenic style, combining elements of Hindu, Islamic and western architecture, it is in the process of becoming the only national-level museum to receive a grant for the Museum Modernisation Project by the Government. Led by museum Director Sabyasachi Mukherjee, the project has made

grand strides in reinventing the museum's role as an icon of the arts. "In five years, the museum will become the cultural hub of the city," he says. It needs to. Although 2,500 people visit it every day, only a 100 are locals while 300 are foreigners. Its honorary curator, R.D. Banerjee, discovered Mohenjo-Daro and his spirit of discovery still infuses the museum's essence. Once doubling as a military hospital during the first World War, it is now hoping its historic past will get a contemporary update.

by Neha Thirani

HIDDEN GEM The Sword of Damocles (1804) painting by Antoine Dubost was gifted by Sir Ratan Tata to the museum in 1922, where it hung unnamed in the European Oil Painting Gallery until discovered by art historian Richard Spear.